

4. Coordinate systems

What students need to learn:

Cartesian equations for the parabola and rectangular hyperbola.

Students should be familiar with the equations:

$$y^2 = 4ax \text{ and } xy = c^2$$

Idea of parametric equations for parabola and rectangular hyperbola.

$$x = at^2, y = 2at \text{ and } x = ct, y = \frac{c}{t}.$$

The idea of $(at^2, 2at)$ and $(ct, \frac{c}{t})$ as general points on the parabola and rectangular hyperbola respectively.

The focus-directrix property of the parabola.

Concept of focus and directrix and parabola as locus of points equidistant from focus and directrix.

Tangents and normals to these curves.

Differentiation of

$$y = 2a^{\frac{1}{2}}x^{\frac{1}{2}}, \quad y = \frac{c^2}{x}.$$

Parametric differentiation is not required.
